

★ = high chance of appearing (ranked against past IBPS PO Mains papers and 2026 bank exams). Each answer is followed by the key fact and its source. Marking: +1.2 right, -0.30 wrong.

1. At Global Fintech Fest 2026, the RBI launched multicurrency forex services on Bharat Connect, which is integrated with CCIL's FX-Retail platform. Which of the following currencies was NOT among the five added alongside the US dollar? ★

Ans (C) Japanese yen

The five currencies added were EUR, GBP, CAD, CHF and AED, in a soft launch at GFF 2026 in Mumbai (Business Today, 9 Sep 2026).

2. NPCI International Payments Ltd (NIPL) partnered with FOMO Pay in September 2026 so that merchants in which country can accept UPI QR payments, with Resorts World Sentosa as the first merchant partner? ★

Ans (B) Singapore

The NIPL-FOMO Pay deal was announced at GFF 2026 on 9 Sep 2026. Indian tourists pay in INR and Singapore merchants settle in SGD (FOMO Pay / Macau Business, 9 Sep 2026).

3. In September 2026, the Finance Ministry secured USD 1 billion from which institution to expand long-term MSME credit through SIDBI? Half came from the institution's own resources and half from a lender syndicate, swapped into rupees through the RBI's special swap window. ★

Ans (B) International Finance Corporation

The IFC provided USD 500 mn from its own resources and the other USD 500 mn is mobilised through a lender syndicate. SIDBI will on-lend to MSMEs for up to 7 years (KNN India, Sep 2026).

4. In September 2026, the RBI issued final Directions on minimum capital requirements for market risk under the Basel III framework for commercial banks. From when do they take effect? ★

Ans (B) 1 April 2027

The RBI (Commercial Banks – Minimum Capital Requirements for Market Risk) Directions, 2026, dated 21 Sep 2026, take effect on 1 Apr 2027. SFBs, payments banks and LABs are excluded (Business Standard / Adda247, Sep 2026).

5. In the 40th edition of the Global Financial Centres Index (GFCI 40), released in September 2026 by Z/Yen Partners and the China Development Institute, what was GIFT City's overall global rank? ★

Ans (A) 37th

GIFT City rose nine places, from 46th in GFCI 39 to 37th in GFCI 40, and entered the Asia-Pacific top 15 (Business Today / DD News, 17 Sep 2026).

6. RBI data released on 11 September 2026 showed a record weekly jump of about USD 44.9 billion in India's foreign exchange reserves, taking them to a lifetime high for the week ended 4 September 2026. What was that level? ★

Ans (D) USD 785.71 billion

Reserves reached USD 785.706 bn for the week ended 4 Sep 2026. Foreign currency assets rose USD 47.5 bn to USD 648.17 bn (RBI Weekly Statistical Supplement; Bloomberg, 11 Sep 2026).

7. Which rating agency upgraded India's long-term sovereign rating from 'BBB+' to 'A-' with a Stable outlook on 2 September 2026, giving India an 'A'-category rating for the first time in about 35 years? ★

Ans (B) Japan Credit Rating Agency (JCR)

JCR upgraded India to A- (Stable) on 2 Sep 2026 and raised the country ceiling to 'A', citing solid growth (7.8% in Q1 FY27) and improved financial-system soundness (ETV Bharat / ThePrint, 2 Sep 2026).

8. The OECD's Interim Economic Outlook of September 2026 raised India's growth projection for FY2026-27 to: ★

Ans (A) 7.1%

The OECD raised India's FY27 forecast by 0.8 percentage points, from 6.3% to 7.1%, and projected 6.5% for FY28 (OECD Interim Report, Sep 2026; Fibre2Fashion).

9. According to NSO data released on 14 September 2026, what was India's CPI-based retail inflation for August 2026? ★

Ans (A) 4.82%

CPI inflation rose to 4.82% in Aug 2026 from 4.45% in July. Food inflation was 5.95% and rural inflation 5.23% (NSO; APAC News Network, 14 Sep 2026).

10. Gross GST collections for August 2026, released on 1 September 2026, grew 14.8% year-on-year to approximately: ★

Ans (A) ₹1.99 lakh crore

Gross GST revenue for August 2026 was ₹1,99,853 crore (+14.8%). Net revenue was ₹1.68 lakh crore (+8.3%) because refunds rose 67.9% (Business Standard / GSTN, 1 Sep 2026).

11. By a Labour Ministry notification under the Code on Social Security, 2020, the EPFO wage ceiling was raised from ₹15,000 per month to what amount, effective 17 September 2026? ★

Ans (A) ₹25,000

Notification S.O. 5109(E) of 17 Sep 2026 set the ceiling at ₹25,000, the first increase since 2014, after Cabinet approval on 16 Sep. It is expected to bring over 51 lakh more workers under EPF (PMIndia / SCC Online, Sep 2026).

12. The 18th BRICS Summit, held on 12–13 September 2026 under India's chairship, adopted the 'New Delhi Declaration'. At which venue was the summit held? ★

Ans (B) Bharat Mandapam

Leaders met at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi, on 12–13 Sep 2026 and adopted the New Delhi Declaration (PIB / ANI / DD India, 12–13 Sep 2026).

13. In the World Economic Forum's Travel & Tourism Development Index 2026, released in September 2026, what was India's rank? ★

Ans (C) 31st

India rose nine places to 31st with a score of 4.42. Japan topped the index, knocking the US to second (WEF TTDI 2026; Business Today / Fortune India, 25–26 Sep 2026).

14. What was India's rank in the WEF Global Gender Gap Index 2026, released in September 2026? ★

Ans (A) 131st

India stayed unchanged at 131st of 145 countries, while Iceland retained the top spot (WEF GGGR 2026; The Hindu / Jagran Josh, 16–17 Sep 2026).

15. The 2026 edition of the Indian Air Force's multinational air exercise 'Tarang Shakti', in which US F-35 fighters made their debut in an Indian exercise, began in late September 2026 at which Air Force Station? ★

Ans (C) Jodhpur

Tarang Shakti 2026 began its operational phase at AFS Jodhpur on 27 Sep 2026 with seven foreign air forces; about 40 countries are taking part or observing (DD News / Times of India, 27 Sep 2026).

16. Which veteran actor received the Dadasaheb Phalke Award from President Droupadi Murmu at the 72nd National Film Awards in Ekta Nagar (Kevadia), Gujarat, on 22 September 2026? ★

Ans (C) Anant Nag

President Murmu conferred the Dadasaheb Phalke Award on Anant Nag at the 72nd National Film Awards in Ekta Nagar, Gujarat (PIB / The Hindu, 22 Sep 2026).

17. India won a record-extending eighth Women's Asia Cup title (2026, T20 format) on 13 September 2026 in Dubai. Which team did India beat in the final? ★

Ans (C) Sri Lanka

India made 183/5 and beat defending champions Sri Lanka by 72 runs; Shafali Verma scored 68 and Shree Charani took 4/20 (ICC / ANI / The Indian Express, 13 Sep 2026).